Charles' transactions over which I have no control whatever. For instance Charles has about Ts 10,000. of Cash the produce of the sales in Teheran and instead of sending it on here to go to England which would have been the only just way of doing, he enters into speculations with the Ghilan people for silk of which speculation I know nothing until the affair is settled and the money paid add to which I am made responsible for his debts in this country and am nailed down to Tabreez to pay those debts but I have fifty grievances which I can not put upon paper. Twigg who returns to England with Charles will tell you more in an hours conversation than I could put upon a quire of paper. —

The silk and musket speculations which I explained pretty fully to my father in my last letter of July 18th are likely to turn out very profitably for Charles, but then he had no right to engage in them, not having sent enough down to buy his debts in England.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO THE SECRETARY OF THE LONDON ZOOLOGICAL SOCIETY]

Tabreez, October 12, 1837

Having heard that some skins of birds sent to England from the neighbourhood of Erzeroum and Trebizonde have been thought interesting I have taken the liberty of sending to the Society two birds of the partridge kind, which, as they are rare in this country, I hope may not be found unworthy of the Societys acceptance.[44]

They are called in the language of the natives of this country, Turkish, "vōr keklik" and in Persian, "cafik i ders," which may be translated "partridge of the wilderness."

These birds were sent to me in the month of July last and I put them into a small garden adjoining my house and fed them on wheat but they also eat a great quantity of the leaves and even stalks of kidney beans and other kitchen garden plants and upon this food they became fat and seemed healthy.

They inhabit the most inaccessible and highest places in the mountains of Persia, and do not descend towards the plains in winter, which in this country even in the plains, is exceedingly severe. They are said to feed at that season, when the whole country is covered with snow, on the sides of the steepest banks and rocky ravines facing the south, where the snow never remains long and is never deep, and there they find in plenty the seeds of the mountain plants which grow in such places, and which I have observed to form the chief food of the red legged partridge, which is numerous here.

[44] It seems improbable that these birds reached the Society, since no mention is made of either the birds or their donor in the *Proceedings* of the Zoological Society of London, nor in any of the other publications of this society. Abbott appears several times in the *Proceedings*, 1830–1838. It is interesting to note that Bruton St., No. 33, was the first headquarters of the Society.

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